

Databases

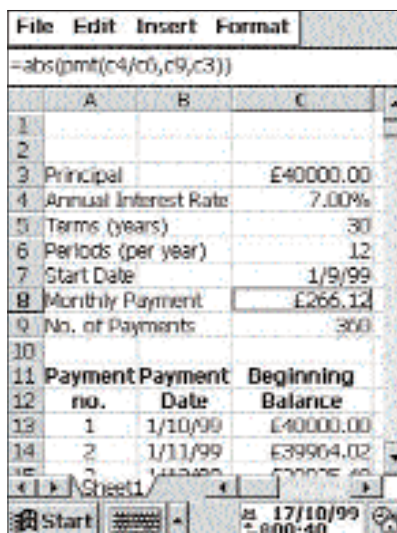
SprintDB Pro is arguably the best program to create databases on a Pocket PC handheld. It is fast, compact and easy-to-use, whilst supporting both Pocket Access files and letting you create custom databases. It also allows for direct printing from a handheld via Infra-red and serial connections.

Office suites

While a single product to take care of all office application needs is absent, several stand-alone products do a wonderful job of filling in. SpreadCE is a spreadsheet application with around 300 functions, and is generally considered much more powerful than Pocket Excel.

PhatPad, an advanced notes organiser, is widely used for basic editing needs. It allows you to draw pictures, jot text notes, or put a mix of pictures and typed text on a virtual scratch pad. There's flexibility in editing options such as Undo and Copy and Paste. You can also export your notes and drawings as JPEG or BMP files, e-mail them as attachments, or transfer them between handhelds via Infra-red.

ProWord is the best dictionary program on the Pocket PC platform. It includes up to 150,000 definitions, and is fairly quick to load and run.



File Edit Insert Format			
=abs(pmt(c4/c6,c9,c3))			
	A	B	C
1			
2			
3	Principal		E40000.00
4	Annual Interest Rate		7.00%
5	Terms (years)		30
6	Periods (per year)		12
7	Start Date		1/9/99
8	Monthly Payment		E266.12
9	No. of Payments		360
10			
11	Payment	Payment	Beginning
12	no.	Date	Balance
13	1	1/10/99	E40000.00
14	2	1/11/99	E39964.02
15			
Sheet1			
Start 17/10/99 9:00:40			

SpreadCE does a pretty good job of mimicking Microsoft Excel on the PC

Messaging

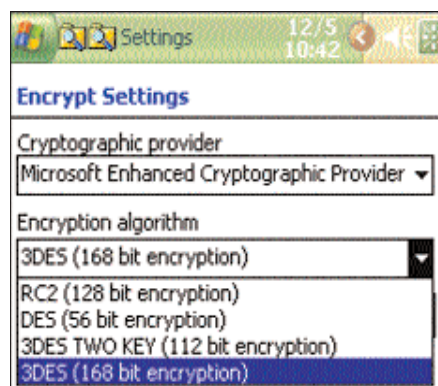
A Pocket PC version of MSN Messenger is available from Microsoft. Also for download, are appropriate versions of ICQ, AOL Instant Messenger and Odigo. Yahoo! Messenger is missing, though.

If you're looking for a means to access Web-based e-mail on your handheld, OneMail provides a comprehensive solution. You can access all your Yahoo!, MSN, AOL, and Hotmail accounts. It can also act as an offline browser.

Utilities

You will find several replacement file managers and browsers to the default explorer on the Pocket PC platform. Resco Explorer 2003, for example, is a decent tool to browse your file system with, offering much more than the default. It is quite like Windows Explorer—it shows all the files and folders on your handheld and storage card. It is also pretty handy if you want to encrypt your files or to compress them. Total Commander is also a similar program, moreover it is free.

If battery life is a concern, you can underclock your handheld using a program such as the Pocket Hack Master. Finally, Remover is a good tool to keep your machine clean of stray files and other trash, while BatteryPack 2003 performs a host of neat tricks such as monitoring battery life and storage space on your handheld.



You can encrypt your files or compress them to save space

Live Organised!

Most people still wonder about the use of a PDA, and whether it could actually be useful for them. Here are some scenarios where the basic functionalities of a PDA would be of practical use for anyone.

- If you need to get up a bit early, you'd probably use an alarm clock. You can set an alarm on a PDA, and set it to ring at regular intervals. Moreover, you can set recurrent alarms, which saves you time—and you don't have to remember to set an alarm every day.
- If you maintain your contacts in a diary, and you lose it often, you can use a PDA and punch in all your contacts with their various details such as e-mail, company name and so on. All your contacts remain intact and in one place.
- At office, you've got things you need to do, and you're lost if you rely on, say, your personal assistant to remember them for you. Now you can stop relying on anyone—use a PDA as your

personal reminder.

- Every file you've noted down on your PDA can be beamed across to a cell phone or a PC, so you can work with them whenever you like. Similarly, you can transfer your files onto the PDA and work with them while on the move.
- If you get drained out after getting home from office, you can keep up your good spirits using your PDA—listen to your favourite MP3s or play games. You can also download Web pages for offline browsing, so you can read them as and when you like.
- One tends to carry magazines on a journey. For a change, transfer your favourite e-book onto your weightless PDA.
- So many of us have business clients or relatives abroad, and some of us tend to forget that there is such a thing as time difference. You don't want to wake up your cousin at an ungodly hour; use a PDA to view world times in a glance.